Ingredients
Know what's inside.

Ingredients – Guide (version 2)

October 2026 · new layout with the bar at the bottom · for Android 7.0 and newer

Ingredients checks food for you: scan the barcode and the app tells you whether the product suits your profile (no pork or alcohol, vegetarian, vegan, allergies, health) – and **why**, with sources. Free, no ads, your data stays on your phone.

Contents

1. Part A — Install the app

1. The home screen and the bottom bar
2. Settings (the gear)
3. Create the profiles (once)
4. What I avoid, allergies
5. My health and My rules
6. Scan a product
7. Read the result
8. Why? and alternatives
9. The highlighted ingredient list
10. Health
11. An ingredient's page
12. Compare two products
13. History and favourites
14. Shopping: the list
15. Shopping: till receipts (new)
16. Add a receipt
17. View a receipt
18. Search for a product (magnifying glass)
19. Photograph a label, add a product
20. Report an error, updates, delete everything

Part A — Install the app

Which APK? On the download page: **"Standard"** fits almost every phone since 2017. If the phone says "App not installed" or "not compatible", take **"Older phones (32-bit)"**. If unsure: **"Universal"** (bigger, works everywhere).

Before you start

- Be on **Wi-Fi** (the file is about **57 MB**, "Universal" 121 MB).

- Have at least **500 MB** free: **Settings → Battery and device care → Storage**.
- The APK from the download page.

Method 1 — Directly on the phone (10 minutes)

1. **Turn off Auto Blocker** (Samsung): **Settings → Security and privacy → Auto Blocker → Off** (confirm with your PIN).
2. **Turn off Android "Advanced Protection"**, if your phone has it: type *Advanced Protection* in the Settings search bar. If it is on, turn it off (it forbids any installation outside the Play Store). If the search finds nothing, go to the next step.
3. **Download the APK**: open the link in **Chrome**. If Chrome warns "this type of file can harm your device", tap **Download anyway**. Wait for the download to finish.
4. **Open the file from "My Files"** (not from the notification): **My Files → Downloads → the .apk file**.
5. **Allow this source**: the phone says "your phone is not allowed to install unknown apps from this source". Tap **Settings**, turn on **Allow from this source**, then go back.
   Manual path if needed: **Settings → Apps → ⋮ (top right) → Special access → Install unknown apps → My Files** (and also **Chrome**) → **Allowed**.
6. Tap **Install**.
7. **If Google Play Protect blocks it** ("App blocked to protect your device" or "Unsafe app blocked"): tap **More details** → **Install anyway**.
   If there is only **OK**: open **Play Store → your profile picture (top right) → Play Protect → ⚙ (gear)** and turn off **"Scan apps with Play Protect"**, then repeat from step 4.
8. Open **Ingredients**. Done.
9. **Turn the protections back on**: Auto Blocker **on**, Play Protect **on**, and remove the "Install unknown apps" permission from My Files and Chrome. The app stays installed and keeps receiving updates.

It doesn't work? Find your message

What you see	Cause	Solution
"Installation blocked" / "blocked by Auto Blocker"	Auto Blocker still on	Step 1. Check that it really is **Off**, then restart the phone.
"...not allowed to install unknown apps from this source"	The app opening the file lacks permission	Step 5, for **My Files** AND **Chrome** (and WhatsApp/Gmail if the file came from there).

“Blocked by Play Protect” / “Unsafe app blocked”	Google doesn’t know the app	Step 7 (“Install anyway”, or turn off the Play Protect scan during the installation).
“App not installed” / “… package conflicts with an existing package”	An old Ingredients version from another source is installed	Uninstall the old Ingredients (long press on the icon → Uninstall), then install again. Settings must be set again.
“App not installed” / “not compatible” with no other detail	Wrong processor type, incomplete file or not enough space	Take **“Older phones (32-bit)”** or **“Universal”** on the download page. Check that the file is complete (57, 48 or 121 MB) in My Files; otherwise delete it and download again on Wi-Fi. Free some space.
“Parse error” / “There was a problem parsing the package”	File damaged during the download	Delete it and download again (method 1), or transfer it another way (method 2).
Nothing happens when tapping the file	Opened from the notification or a preview	Open it from **My Files** → **Downloads**.
“Blocked by your administrator” / work phone	Phone managed by a company (Knox, work profile)	Cannot be bypassed: use a personal phone.
Everything done and it still refuses	Unidentified Samsung/Google block	**Method 3** (USB cable + computer): it bypasses the phone’s installer.

Method 2 — Get the file another way

Useful if the download fails or the file is damaged. The .apk file can be sent:

- by **Quick Share** from another Samsung phone or a Windows PC (the file arrives in **My Files → Downloads**);
- by **USB cable** from a computer: connect the phone, choose **File transfer** in the USB notification, copy the file into the phone’s *Download* folder.

Then continue method 1 from **step 4**.

Method 3 — USB cable + computer (always works)

This method worked when the direct installation was refused. You need a computer (Windows, Mac or Linux) and a USB-C cable that transfers data.

On the phone:

1. Turn on developer options: **Settings → About phone → Software information** → tap "Build number" **7 times** (enter your PIN). The message "Developer mode has been turned on" appears.
2. **Settings → Developer options** → turn on **USB debugging**.
3. Connect the phone to the computer, **unlock the screen**. At "Allow USB debugging?", tick **Always allow from this computer** → **Allow**.

On the computer:

1. Download Google's official "Android SDK Platform-Tools": developer.android.com/tools/releases/platform-tools, and unzip the *platform-tools* folder (e.g. to *C:\platform-tools*).
2. Download the .apk file to the computer (e.g. into *Downloads*).
3. Open a terminal in the *platform-tools* folder (Windows: in Explorer, type `cmd` in the address bar and press Enter) and type:

```
adb devices
```

The phone must appear with the word `device`. If it says `unauthorized`, look at the phone and tap **Allow**. Then:

```
adb install -r "%USERPROFILE%\Downloads\ingredients.apk"
```

(replace with the real file name; on Mac/Linux: `./adb install -r ~/Downloads/ingredients.apk`). When `Success` appears, it is installed.

To finish: **Developer options → USB debugging** → **off**.

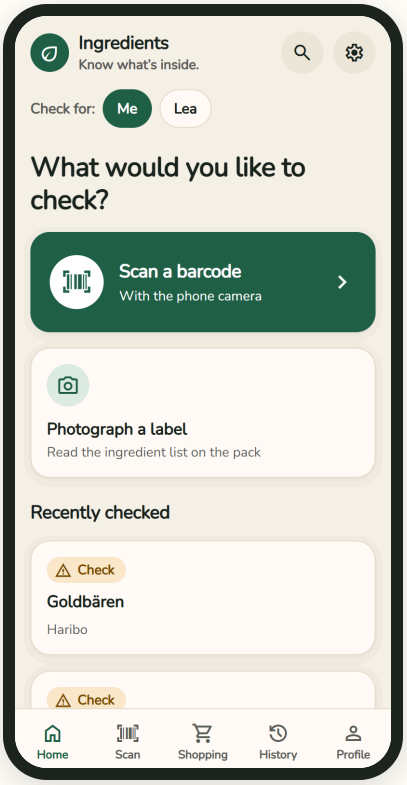
> **Safety:** only install APKs from a source you know (here: this page). Always turn Auto Blocker and Play Protect back on after the installation.

After the installation: updates

- Each time it opens, the app downloads the new version in the background. A banner **"A new version of the app is ready"** offers **Restart to install it**.
- At the very bottom of the home screen, the **App version** block shows the version and a **Check for an update** button.
- No new APK needed, unless you are explicitly asked.

Part B — Use the app

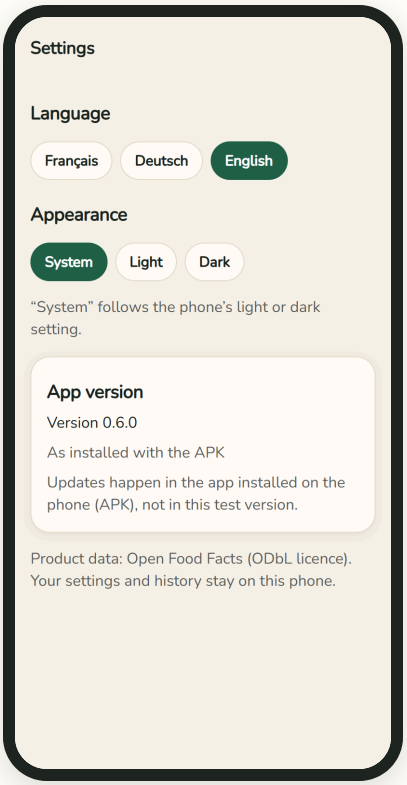
1 The home screen and the bottom bar



Five buttons always stay at the bottom – one tap to switch:

- **Home** · **Scan** · **Shopping** · **History** · **Profile**.
- Top right: the **magnifying glass** 🔍 to search for a product by name or brand, and the **gear** ⚙ for settings.
- **Check for:** shows whose profile is used (when there are several). Tap a name to switch.
- The big green **Scan a barcode** button is the quickest; below it, **Photograph a label**.
- **Recently checked**: your last three products, with **Full history**. At the bottom: **Share the app**.

2 Settings (the gear)

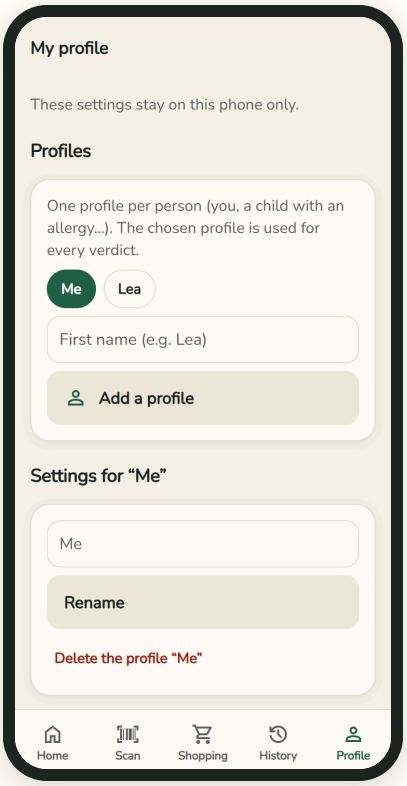


1. Home → gear ⚙ top right.
2. **Language**: **Français**, **Deutsch** or **English**. On first launch, the app uses the phone's language.
3. **Appearance**: *System* (like the phone), *Light* or *Dark*.
4. **App version**: your version and **Check for an update**.

3 Create the profiles (once)

Bottom bar → **Profile**. Everything stays **on your phone only**.

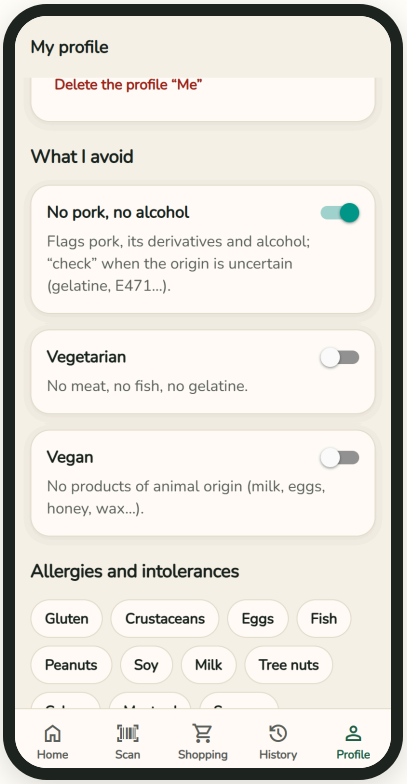
1. Under **Profiles**, “Me” already exists. For another person (e.g. a child with an allergy): type a first name → **Add a profile**.
2. The profile **in green** is the one you are setting up, and the one used for every verdict.
3. **Rename** changes the name; “Delete the profile …” removes it (after a confirmation).



4 What I avoid, allergies

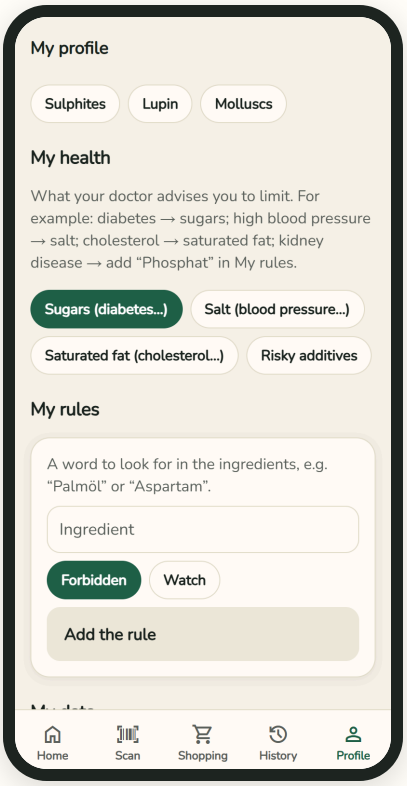
1. **What I avoid**: switches *No pork, no alcohol*, *Vegetarian*, *Vegan*. Under each one, exactly what is checked.
2. **Allergies and intolerances**: tap the 14 EU allergens that concern you. Selected ones turn green.

Without a profile, the app explains the ingredients but gives no verdict.



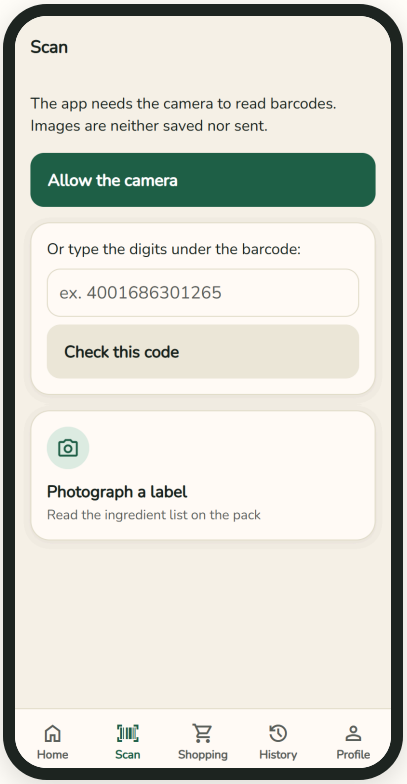
5 My health and My rules

1. **My health**: what your doctor advises you to limit – *Sugars*, *Salt*, *Saturated fat*, *Risky additives*. A product high in it then becomes “Check”.
2. **My rules**: your own word to look for, e.g. “Palmöl” (palm oil). *Forbidden* or *Watch* → **Add the rule**. Deleted by mistake? An **Undo** bar appears for a few seconds.



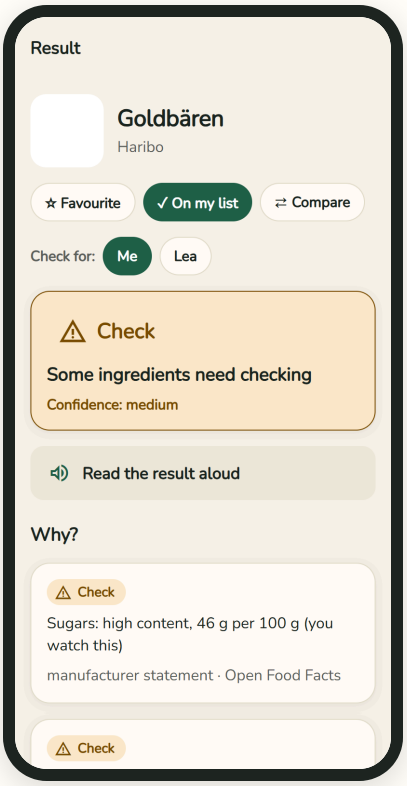
6 Scan a product

1. Bottom bar → **Scan** (or, on the home screen, **Scan a barcode**).
2. The first time: **Allow the camera**. Images are neither saved nor sent.
3. Hold the barcode inside the frame: it turns **green**, the phone **vibrates**, the result opens.
4. Not reading? Type the digits under the barcode → **Check this code**.
5. On the same page: **Photograph a label** when a product is unknown.



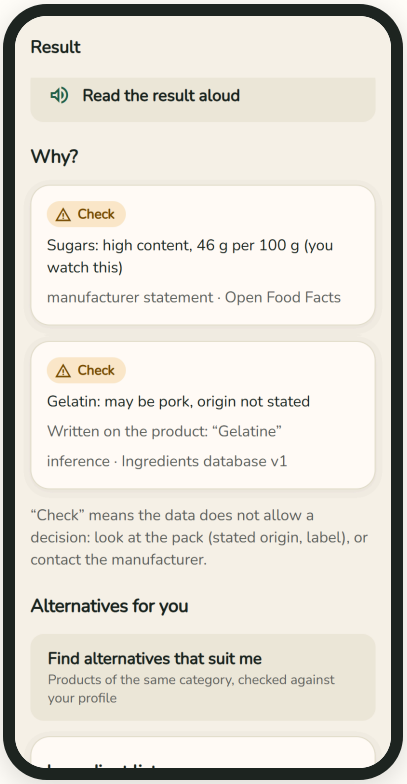
7 Read the result

1. At the top: photo, name and brand of the product.
2. Three buttons: **☆ Favourite**, **+ Shopping list**, **⇄ Compare**.
3. **The verdict** in a coloured card: **✓ Suitable**, **! Check**, **✕ Not suitable** or **? Unknown**. Below it, the **confidence**.
4. **Read the result aloud**: the phone reads the verdict. The arrow top left takes you back where you were.



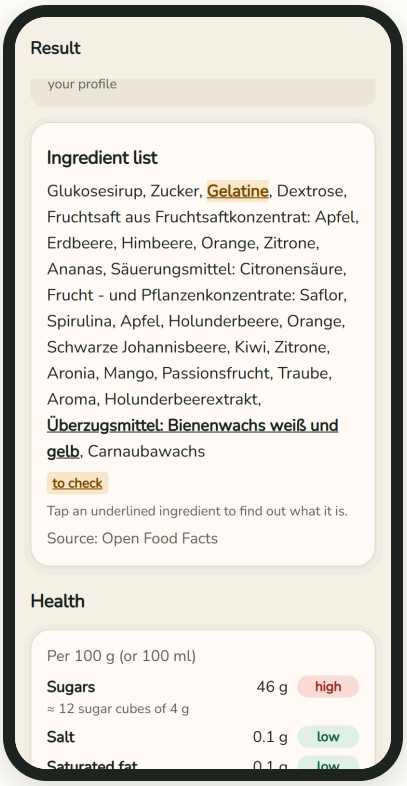
8 Why? and alternatives

1. **Why?** lists every reason for the verdict, with the word as written on the pack and its source.
2. "Check" means the data does not allow a sure answer (e.g. gelatine without the animal stated): look at the pack or ask the manufacturer.
3. **Find alternatives that suit me**: products of the same category that suit you. **No advertising**.



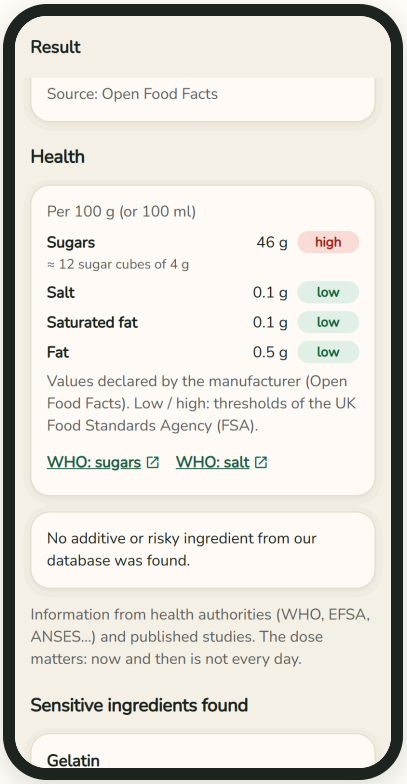
9 The highlighted ingredient list

- **red** = you avoid it · **orange** = to check · **purple** = health: watch.
- **Underlined** = explained ingredient: tap it. **Dotted** = not known to the app yet.



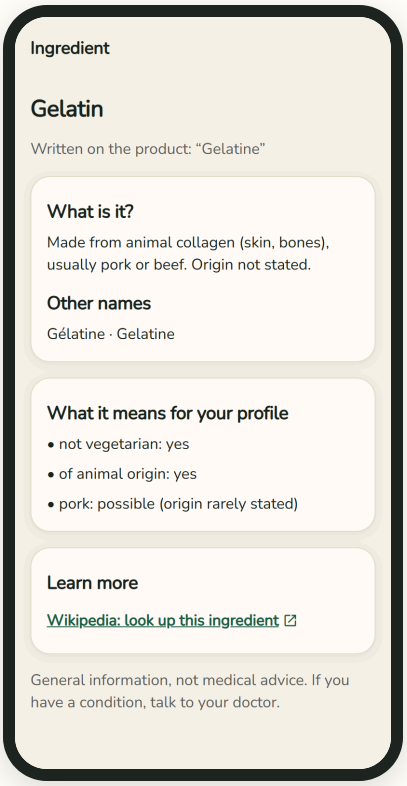
10 Health

- Sugars, salt, saturated fat and fat **per 100 g**, with *low / moderate / high*; sugars in sugar cubes, salt as a % of the WHO maximum.
- Risky ingredients and their sources (WHO, EFSA…). A healthy product gets **Good choice!**



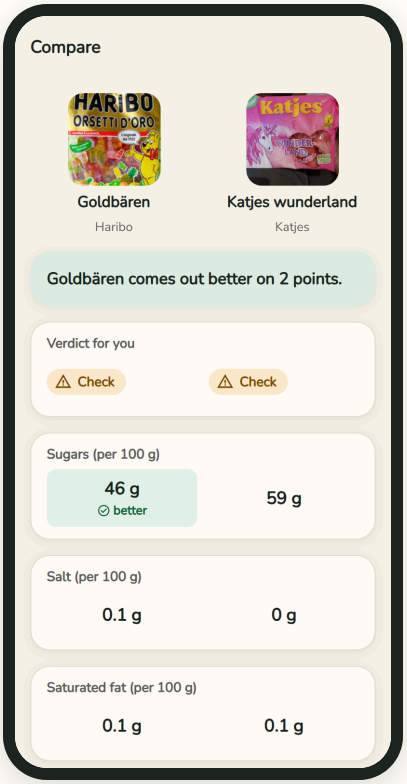
11 An ingredient's page

- **What is it?**, **Other names** (E numbers too), **In detail** for tricky cases.
- **What it means for your profile**, effects on health, **official and checked sources** with the date of the check.



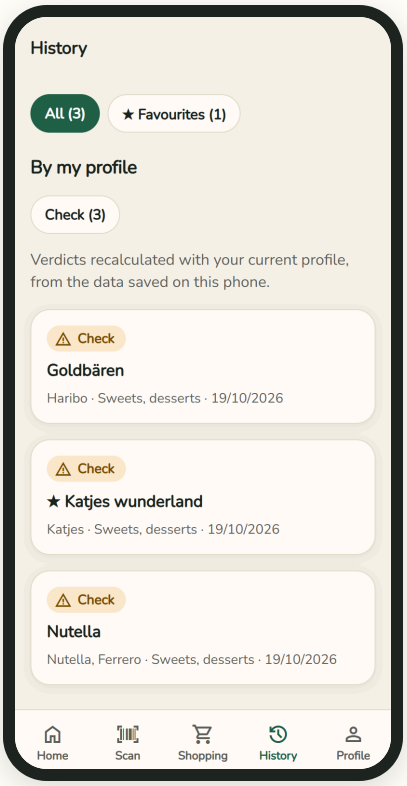
12 Compare two products

1. On a product: ⇄ **Compare**, then scan or pick the 2nd product.
2. Both side by side: verdict, sugars, salt, fat, additives, Nutri-Score. The better one is marked **better**.



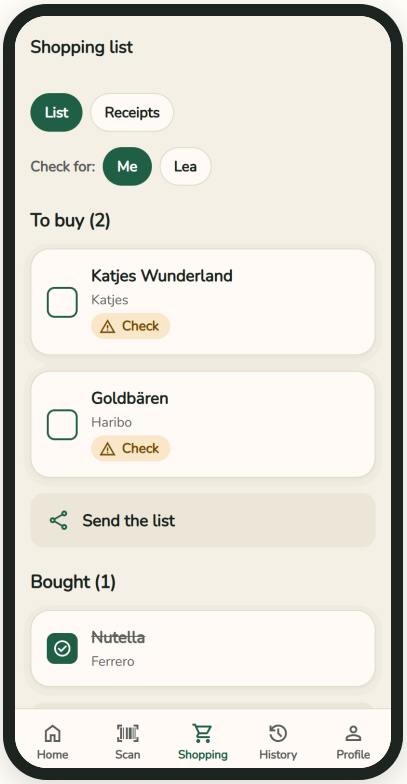
13 History and favourites

- Bottom bar → **History** : every product you opened, even offline.
- Filters: *All* / ★ *Favourites*, by verdict and by category. Verdicts are recalculated with the chosen profile.



14 Shopping: the list

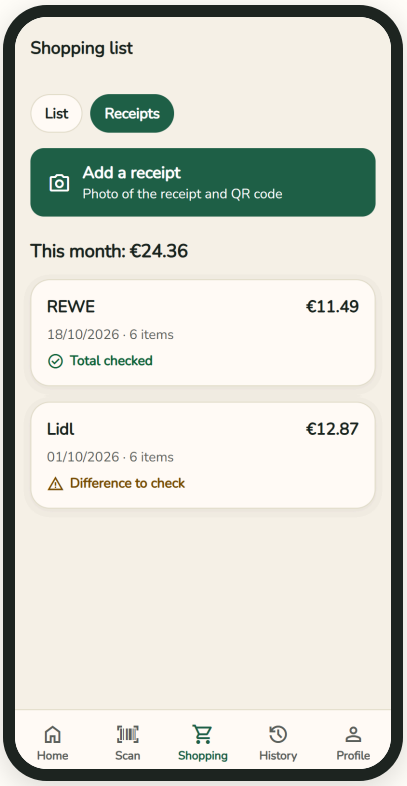
1. On a product: **+ Shopping list** .
2. Bottom bar → **Shopping** → at the top **List** : tick what you bought; **Send the list** by WhatsApp, SMS or e-mail.
3. Shopping for someone else? Choose their profile at the top: a red banner flags items that don't suit them.



15 Shopping: till receipts (new)

After shopping, keep an eye on what you spend.

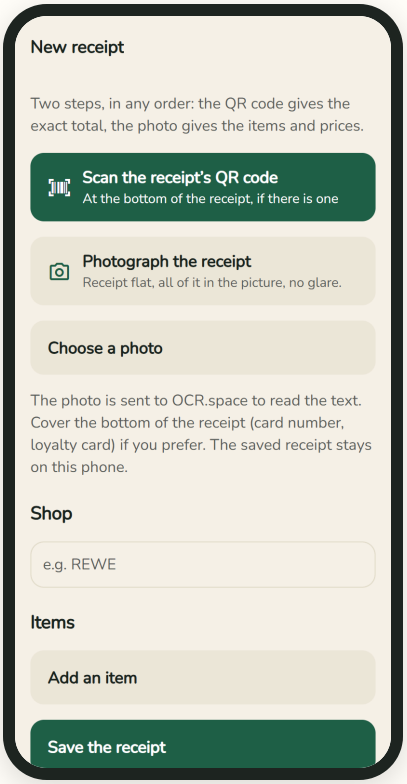
1. Bottom bar → **Shopping** → at the top **Receipts**.
2. **This month**: total of all receipts of the current month.
3. Each receipt shows the shop, date, number of items and amount. **Total checked**: the items add up exactly to the receipt total. **Difference to check**: an item is missing or a price was misread.



16 Add a receipt

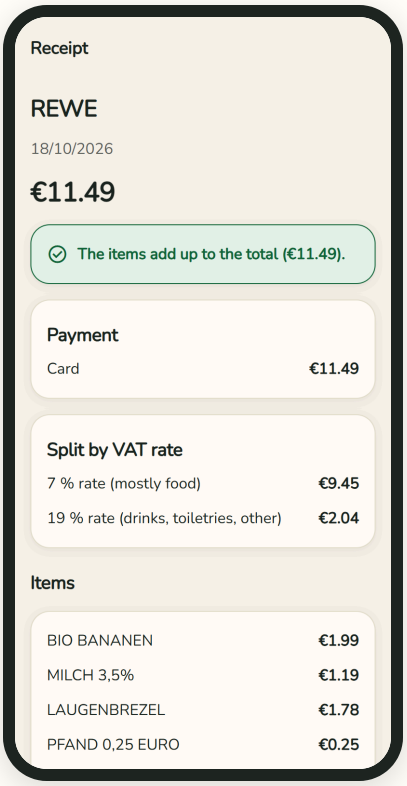
1. **Add a receipt**. Two steps, in any order:
2. **Scan the receipt's QR code** (at the bottom, if there is one): exact total, VAT, cash or card, date.
3. **Photograph the receipt**: flat, all of it in the picture, no glare. The app reads the items and prices and recognises the shop.
4. Check and correct the items (name, price; a discount with a minus: *-0.30*). **Add an item** for anything missed.
5. The **Total check** compares the items with the receipt total → **Save the receipt**.

The photo is sent to OCR.space to read the text. Cover the bottom of the receipt (card number, loyalty card) if you prefer. Saved receipts stay on the phone.



17 View a receipt

- Tap a receipt: total, result of the check, **Payment** (cash / card) and **Split by VAT rate** – 7 % is mostly food, 19 % drinks, toiletries and the rest.
- Below, every item with its price. Discounts and returned bottles show in green with a minus.
- **Delete this receipt** removes it (after a confirmation).



18 Search for a product (magnifying glass)

1. Home → magnifying glass 🔍 top right.
2. Type a name or brand (German often works best) → **Search**. Each result is checked against your profile; *Only the ones that suit me* filters.

19 Photograph a label, add a product

- **Photograph a label** (home or Scan tab): photograph the “Zutaten” paragraph flat and sharp, check the text → **Analyse**.
- Unknown product: **Add this product to Open Food Facts** – with your free account on openfoodfacts.org. It is then recognised **for everyone**.

20 Report an error, updates, delete everything

- **Report an error** (at the bottom of every result): a ready-made e-mail, without your profile.
- **Updates** arrive by themselves: “A new version of the app is ready” → **Restart**. To check yourself: **Gear → App version → Check for an update**.
- **Profile → My data → Delete everything**: profiles, history, favourites, shopping list, receipts and account are erased from the phone.

Part C — Good to know

- The app **replaces neither the pack, nor your doctor, nor a religious authority**. It certifies nothing. With a severe allergy, always read the label.
- When it doesn’t know, it says so (“Unknown”, low confidence).
- No ads, no required account. Product data: Open Food Facts (ODbL licence). To read a photo, the image is sent to the OCR.space service; your profile, never.
- Questions or ideas? Write to draboibro@gmail.com.